

A+E

THERE GOES CHICAGO!

Godzilla finally gets to the Midwest in new comic book



IDW PUBLISHING

LIFE+TRAVEL

Making halal accessible

From nail polish to meat, Barrington couple seek to offer products and services for America's growing Muslim population.

REAL ESTATE

Need a down payment?

Many don't realize there are myriad programs that offer grants or loans to help homebuyers come up with the necessary funds.



‘THEY’RE TRYING TO MAKE US DISAPPEAR’

Trump’s attacks on trans community sow fear and paralysis in Illinois

By Jonathan Bullington | Chicago Tribune

Ben Garcia thinks of himself as a typical high school senior. He plays Fortnite in a room his mom says is too messy. He watches TV with her on weeknights in their Rogers Park apartment — “Severance” and “Will Trent” are their current favorites. And every so often, he goes to Olive Garden with his friends for what they call an “old man dinner.”

But these days, the 18-year-old feels like his mere existence is seen as a threat by a U.S. government that wants to force him to return to a time when something as simple as using a public bathroom could cause debilitating anxiety.

“I just don’t get it,” he said, tugging at the sleeve of his Lane Tech High School sweatshirt. “I think if a lot of people met a trans person, and I’m sure they have and just didn’t know, they would see that it’s not this big scheme to try to do whatever it is they think trans people are doing. It’s just that this is how I am most comfortable, and that’s it.”

Garcia is one of an estimated 1.6 million transgender Americans targeted in a series of executive orders issued by President Donald Trump during his first month in office.

The wide-ranging orders seek to strip transgender, nonbinary and intersex people of the ability to change their gender markers on passports or to serve in the military. They aim to force transgender women in federal prison to be housed with men and to bar them from participation in female sports.

The orders also attempt to end gender-affirming care for transgender people younger than 19, and

Above: Ben Garcia, right, and his friend Verlander Thompkins III stand at Addison Street and Western Avenue in Chicago after getting out of class at Lane Tech High School on Feb. 13. EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The hidden world of Chicago ICE arrests

1 month after Trump’s inauguration, a partial look at those detained

By Madeline Buckley, Nell Salzman, Caroline Kubzansky and Joe Mahr
Chicago Tribune

Immigration agents swept the Chicago area on Jan. 26 and their presence quickly rippled across the city and suburbs, lighting up phone screens with frenzied reports of sightings.

A Hermosa couple hid in their attic when agents were spotted on the street. An agent in an ICE vest walked past homes in South Chicago. Government officials stood in a ring with geared-up law enforcement in a photo posted to social media. TV personality Phil McGraw joined in, contributing to the sense of spectacle, even as residents hid in their homes in fear.

The scenes played out in neighborhoods on the North, South and West sides of the city, along the Indiana border and in the suburbs after six days of anticipatory tension following the inauguration of President Donald Trump.

U.S. Immigration and Customs and Enforcement publicized more than 950 arrests nationwide that day, and Chicago Police Superintendent Larry Snelling said at least 100 people were arrested in Chicago and the surrounding area.

A month later, though, precise information about who was swept up and why remains elusive, as federal officials have declined to

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INSIDE



BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Bears gauging the free-agent market

Will the Bears, flush with salary-cap space, be “aggressive” in free agency this offseason? Brad Biggs’ thoughts entering the NFL combine. **Chicago Sports**

Is May 7 Real ID deadline for real?

Federal officials are not offering clear instructions on how the deadline for Real ID will be enforced, and there are indications it may be phased in. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Kremlin says prep for summit ongoing

Work is in the early stages for a face-to-face meeting between President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin, an official says. **Nation & World**

Pritzker offers searing rebuke of Trump 2.0

Governor compares president’s administration to Nazi Germany. But will voters be moved?

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

For just over a half-hour Wednesday, Gov. JB Pritzker’s combined budget and State of the State address followed an expected course, detailing spending and initiatives for a new budget year while warning of the economic uncertainty ahead for the state and its residents under President Donald Trump and his “haphazard ‘ready, fire, aim’ tactics toward everyday Americans.”

But then, the Democratic governor abruptly shifted course. For the nearly six-minute conclusion of his speech, he delivered a dark, foreboding historical narrative — a leading Jewish-American voice offering a version of the Holocaust education warning of

“Never Forget” as he likened the actions of Trump and his administration to the quick rise of Nazism in Germany.

“I do not invoke the specter of Nazis lightly. But I know the history intimately — and have spent more time than probably anyone in this room with people who survived the Holocaust. Here’s what I’ve learned: The root that tears apart your house’s foundation begins as a seed, a seed of distrust and hate and blame,” Pritzker said.

“I’m watching with a foreboding dread what is happening in our country right now,” he said, referring to efforts to eliminate diversity programs and marginalize people on the basis of their race, ethnicity or sexual



BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

“If we don’t want to repeat history, then for God’s sake in this moment we better be strong enough to learn from it.”

— Gov. JB Pritzker in his State of the State address; he is shown above in his ceremonial office after delivering the address on Wednesday

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